



THE PERFECT LOOK

New research is beginning to explain the hows of finding the right match

|By Damayanti Datta|

It's February and love is in the air. There's a flurry of pink balloons and red roses, chocolates and diamonds. It may be the time for an overly pink, commerce hypefest. But it's also a great excuse to work out that eternally fascinating question: Why do some people make our hearts beat a little faster? For centuries it has been an unresolved mystery. We have been told that standards of beauty and attractiveness are arbitrary—in the eye of the beholder. But now a slew of research, surveys and studies has started to piece together some of the clues to this complex phenomenon and are throwing up surprising answers.

Boy meets girl. And Cupid takes care of everything else. That sizzling love-at-first-sight romance one reads about came true for newly-wed Simran, 23, and Ricky Mann, 28, of Chandigarh. Their journey to the altar started with one life-changing meet-and-greet at a friend's place. Level-